

OCCUPATIONAL ENGLISH TEST

WRITING SUB-TEST: MEDICINE

TIME ALLOWED: READING TIME: 5 MINUTES
 WRITING TIME: 40 MINUTES

Read the case notes below and complete the writing task which follows.

Notes:

Mrs Katherine Walter is a patient in your general practice.

History: Name: Mrs Katherine Walter
 DOB: 26 November, 1975
 Height: 170cm
 Asthma – since childhood; budesonide (Pulmicort) inhaler, since 28/06/99
 Chronic fungal skin infections (both feet) – currently clotrimazole (Canesten)
 Moderate family Hx depression (father, sister, aunt, uncle)
 Married; two children (8 & 11 yrs)
 Home duties
 No hobbies or sport
 Family (parents, husband's parents & siblings) live in other states

19/11/14

Subjective: Here for 'check-up'. Seems well, happy, volunteers at her children's school.
 Reports feeling tired. Asthma controlled, more attacks this year. Fungus on feet
 flares up periodically – Pt reports no creams seem effective. Overweight.

Examination: BP – 110/95
 Heart rate – 76 bpm
 Breast check – no palpable mass found
 Skin check – no suspicious lesions found
 Wt – 82kg
 BMI – 28.4

Tests: Pap smear
 CBC

Assessment: Pt appears well. Needs to ↓weight, ↑exercise. Monitor BMI/fitness/lifestyle.

Plan: Advise Pt re lifestyle changes to ↓weight, ↑exercise. Pt to phone for test results
 in 1 wk. Recommend miconazole (Daktarin) for fungus. R/v appt 3 mths to
 assess fungal infection, weight and fitness.

28/05/15

Subjective: R/v. Pt reports feeling well and energetic. Too busy to come to scheduled r/v 3 mth – didn't think it was necessary. Asthma flared up about two months ago but no attacks since then. Fungus improved. Reports ↑ involvement with school (now president of parents' association). Has lost weight, joined gym (trains daily).

Examination: BP – 108/90
Heart rate – 66 bpm
Wt – 69.5kg
BMI – 24
CBC – all results in normal range (results of test 19/11/14)
Pap smear – no abnormalities found (results of test 19/11/14)

25/07/15

Subjective: Reports feelings of not coping and of wanting to die. Feels tired, but sleeps badly. No energy to complete household tasks, e.g., cooking and cleaning, looking after children.
Feels overwhelmed with responsibilities. Doesn't want to eat.

Examination: BP – 120/90
Heart rate – 78 bpm
Wt – 50kg
BMI – 17.3
Temp – 37.5°C

Assessment: Depression – severe / ?bipolar disorder. Requires urgent treatment.

Plan: Refer to psychiatrist for urgent assessment and treatment for depression/ bipolar disorder and suicidal thoughts. Contact husband to discuss child care, household maintenance, etc.

Writing Task

Using the information in the case notes, write a letter of referral to the psychiatrist, Dr M Jones, 23 Sandy Road, South Seatown.

In your answer:

- Expand the relevant notes into complete sentences
- Do not use note form
- Use letter format

The body of the letter should be approximately 180–200 words.